Speaking questions

Day 3 · Speaking

What to do: Pairs: A asks 4 questions from set A, then B asks 4 from set B. Change partners for set C.

How to answer
Three sentences: **answer + reason + example**. The partner asks one more question. Then swap.
Set A: this week's grammar. Set B: older lessons, mixed. Set C: bigger questions, any grammar you need.

A This week: the past continuous

1. What were you doing at this time yesterday?
2. What were you doing when you last heard really good (or really bad) news?
3. Where were you living five years ago? What were you studying?
4. What was your family doing last night at eight o'clock?
5. Tell me about a time when the lights, the internet or your phone suddenly stopped while you were doing something important.
6. What were you thinking about on the way to class today?
7. Tell me about a time when somebody interrupted you while you were doing something. What did you do?
8. Describe the street outside your home right now: what are people doing? And at this time yesterday?
   present + past

B Older lessons: mixed grammar

1. Where were you last Saturday evening? Who was with you?
   was / were · Week 1
2. What did you do last weekend? What did you plan to do but didn't?
   past simple · Week 2
3. Ask your partner 4 questions about their last holiday: Where? When? Who? How?
   past questions · Week 3
4. Describe the room or the street where you grew up. What was there, and what wasn't?
   there was / were · Week 1
5. What are you going to do after class? What will the world be like in 2050?
   going to / will
6. What do you usually do on Sundays? What are you doing this Sunday?
   present simple + continuous
7. Which is better for a holiday, the sea or the mountains? Why?
   comparatives
8. Tell a five-sentence story with: begin · break · bring · catch · fall.
   irregular verbs

Big questions

Day 3 · Speaking

What to do: Choose two questions per pair and talk for two minutes each. The class listens for one grammar mistake and one good sentence.

C Think, then talk (2 minutes each)

1. Was life better before smartphones? Why or why not?
   technology
2. Can dogs go into cafés and shops in your country? Give reasons for and against.
   animals · opinions
3. What was your best or worst school day? What happened, and how did you feel?
   school · past
4. Do you prefer living in a village or in a big city? Give three reasons.
   places · opinions
5. What did you eat as a child? Do you still eat it? What was your favorite meal?
   food · past simple
6. What do you want to do in ten years? What do you need to do first?
   dreams · future

+ Useful phrases

In my opinion… · I agree because… · On the other hand… · For example… · I was… when… · That reminds me of…

Next lesson (Week 6)
Past simple or past continuous with *when* and *while*: Murphy red, Unit 14, pages 38–39.